KAVEH DANESH
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**Current Position**

Internal Medicine Resident, University of California, San Francisco, 2024–

**Education**

University of California, San Francisco, M.D., 2024

University of California, Berkeley, Ph.D. in Economics, 2023

*Dissertation committee: David Card, Patrick Kline, Jonathan Kolstad, and Emmanuel Saez*

Harvard University, A.M. in Statistics, 2015

Duke University, B.S. in Mathematics, 2012

**Research Fields**

Health Economics, Labor Economics, Public Economics, Applied Econometrics

**Job Market Paper**

The Early-Career Effects of Anxiety and Depression (with Arlen Guarin and Christian Posso)

*Invited presentations at 2026 NBER SI Health, 2026 ASSA Meetings, and 2025 APPAM Fall Research Conference*

**Working Papers**

The Lifecycle Formation of Health Inequality (with Jon Kolstad, Will Parker, and Johannes Spinnewijn)

*Invited presentation at NBER SI 2024; featured on NBER Bulletin on Health*

Sources of Socioeconomic Inequality in Cancer Mortality (with Mieke Aarts, Jon Kolstad, Will Parker, and Johannes Spinnewijn)

The Impacts of Palliative Care on Spending, Suffering, and Mortality

Is Mental Illness Undertreated? Evidence from Integrated Mental Health Care

**Ongoing Work**

Syphilis, Penicillin, and the Black–White Earnings Gap (with David Card)

Inducing Demand for High-Value Care (with Arlen Guarin and Ben Scuderi)

The Health Costs of Untreated Depression: Evidence from a Large Screening Initiative

**Peer-Reviewed Publications**

Chan, D., **Danesh, K.**, Costantini, S., Card, D., Taylor, L., Studdert, D. M. 2022. Mortality among U.S. veterans after emergency visits to Veterans Affairs and other hospitals: retrospective cohort study. *BMJ*, 376

*Cited in testimony before the U.S. House Committee on Veterans' Affairs*

Turner, N., **Danesh, K.**, & Moran, K. 2020. The evolution of infant mortality inequality in the United States, 1960–2016. *Science Advances*, 6(29)

*Cited in the 2024 Economic Report of the President*

**Danesh, K.**, Durrett, R., Havrilesky, L. J., & Myers, E. 2012. A branching process model of ovarian cancer. *Journal of Theoretical Biology*, 314, 10–15

**Invited Presentations**

2026: NBER SI Economics of Health, ASSA Annual Meetings, UC Berkeley Labor Lunch, UC Berkeley Public Seminar, UC Berkeley Labor Seminar

2025: Stone Center Summer Institute, APPAM Fall Research Conference, ZSFG Medicine Mortality & Morbidity Conference

2023: UC Berkeley SPH Latest in Public Health Research Series

2022: UC Berkeley Labor Lunch

2021: UC Berkeley Public Finance Seminar, UC Berkeley Labor Lunch

**Awards, Grants, and Fellowships**

Keith Johnson Award, UCSF Department of Medicine, 2026

*For the second-year resident who best exemplifies the personal and professional qualities of a UCSF physician*

Paul & Daisy Soros Fellowship for New Americans ($90,000), 2017–2019
National Institutes of Health NICHD Training Fellowship ($24,000/yr), 2017–2019
Summer Explore Research Fellowship ($3,500), UCSF School of Medicine, 2018
*Research Mentor: Bob Wachter*
Research grant to study place-based policies, UC Berkeley Opportunity Lab ($18,000), 2018
NBER research grant to study determinants of life expectancy ($11,000), NBER, 2017
Berkeley Graduate Fellowship ($90,000; for top admitted doctoral students), 2016–2018
NDSEG Fellowship for Graduate Study in Mathematics ($32,000/yr plus tuition), 2013–2016
NSF Graduate Research Fellowship Honorable Mention, 2013
Fulbright Fellowship to study areas with high cancer incidence in China ($20,000), 2012–2013

## Peer Review

Invited referee for *Econometrica*, *Review of Economic Studies*, and *Review of Economics and Statistics*

## Teaching

Teaching Assistant for Applied Econometrics (Prof. David Card), UC Berkeley, Spring 2022
*Received Outstanding Graduate Student Instructor Award for top 10% of instructors*
Co-Instructor for My Life, My Story (Dr. Gurpreet Dhaliwal), San Francisco VA, 2021–2023
Small Group Instructor for Life Stages (Dr. Naomi Stotland), UCSF, Fall 2021
Teaching Assistant for Generalized Linear Models (Prof. Mark Glickman), Harvard, Spring 2015
Non-Resident Tutor in Mathematics at Pforzheimer House, Harvard, 2014–2015
Teaching Assistant for Organic Chemistry (Prof. Jim Parise), Duke, Fall 2010

## Research Positions

Research Service Employee, Department of Veterans Affairs, 2017–Present
Research Assistant to David Card and David Chan, UC Berkeley, 2018–2020
Predoctoral Fellow to Emmanuel Saez and Danny Yagan, UC Berkeley, 2015–2016
Research Assistant to Paul Farmer and Agnes Binagwaho, Rwanda Ministry of Health, 2015
Additional research roles with Rick Durrett, Megan O'Rourke, Ziad Obermeyer, and Amartya Sen

## University Service

Medical Ethics Committee, UCSF Parnassus, 2025–2026
Economics PhD Admissions Graduate Student Review Committee, UC Berkeley, 2018–2022
Duke University Board of Trustees, 2012–2015
*Elected to three-year term; served on Academic Affairs and Medical Center Academic Affairs Committees*
Student representative on 10 committees at Duke University between 2009 and 2012
*Served on the Arts & Sciences Council, Quantitative Studies Curriculum Review Committee, Undergraduate Experience Strategic Planning Committee, Academic Affairs Committee of the Board of Trustees, and others*

## Selected Policy Experience

Successfully petitioned to change a California policy affecting the children of migrant farmworkers
*Featured in Chapter 8 of* Advocacy for Public Health Change; *op-ed in the* Sacramento Bee

## Literary Writing

"28 Hours in the ICU." *JAMA*, 2026 *(with accompanying essay by Rafael Campo)*
"Triage of Two Cultures." *Journal of Medical Humanities*, 2019
*Second Place, 37th Annual William Carlos Williams Poetry Competition*
"War and Cancer." *Harvard Advocate*, 2013

## Other Experience

Writer for President Obama, White House Internship Program, Summer 2014
Assistant Coach for Men's Varsity Soccer, Harvard, 2013–2015